

Figure 1: Refurbished HTML 5 Semantics

specs, the editor, Ian Hickson of Google, analysed over a billion Web pages to find out how authors were actually using these elements. He discovered that in the top 20 class names used in the mark-up for this huge set of data, were classes for common requirements: footers, headers, nav, menus, content, and main.

So the HTML 5 specs have a host of new, structural tags such as *header*, *footer*, *nav*, *article*, and *section*, which fit these common requirements and allow us to mark up our archetypal blog with more meaningful elements.

## The <header> element

The header element is for page or section headings. This is not to be confused with a traditional masthead, which often holds just a logo mark, and should also contain one of *h1* to *h6* in hierarchical rank. It could also contain meta information for that page or section of a page like "last updated", a version number, or blog entry information like published date, author, etc.

A simple example for a page using a semantic class name that corresponds to the HTML 5 header might be:

```
<div class="header">
  <h1>Page Title</h1>
</div>
```

You could include the logo mark and other meta information within the layer. The next example for blog articles includes information on the

author and the date published (as well as an example of referencing the section and article elements with semantic class names):

```
<div class="section">
  <div class="article">
    <div class="header">
      <h1>Page Title</h1>
      <p>By <a href="#">Author</a> on [date]</p>
    </div>
    [Article content]
  </div>
</div>
```

## The <nav> element

The *nav* element should contain a set of navigation links, either to other pages, or fragment identifiers in the current page. Referencing it with semantic class names is simple:

```
<div class="nav">
  <ul>
    <li><a href="#">Menu item 1</a></li>
    <li><a href="#">Menu item 2</a></li>
  </ul>
</div>
```

## The <aside> element

The *aside* element is for content that is tangentially related to the content around it, and is typically useful for

marking up sidebars.

```
<aside>
  <h1>Archives</h1>
  <ul>
    <li><a href="/2007/09/">Sep 09</a></li>
    <li><a href="/2007/08/">Aug 09</a></li>
    <li><a href="/2007/07/">Jul 09</a></li>
  </ul>
</aside>
```

## The <section> element

The *section* element represents a generic section of a document or application, such as a chapter, for example.

```
<section>
  <h1>Chapter 1: The Period</h1>
  <p>It was the best of times, it was the worst of times,
    it was the age of wisdom, it was the age of foolishness,
    it was the epoch of belief, it was the epoch of incredulity,
    it was the season of Light, it was the season of Darkness.
  <p>
</section>
```

## The <figure> element

The *figure* element contains embedded media like *img* and

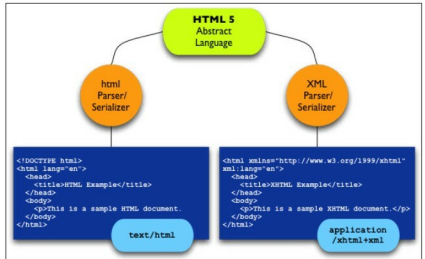


Figure 2: HTML 5 is being written in two syntaxes: HTML and XML (Source: <http://www.w3.org/0A/2008/01/html5-is-html-and-xml.html>)